

Table 1: Workforce Characteristics, Janitors, 2001-2025

Contractor = Outsourced; In-House = Directly Employed

	2001-2005		2006-2010		2011-2015		2016-2019		2021-2025	
	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor	In-house	Contractor
Employment and wages										
Mean hourly wage (2025\$)	\$18.58	\$16.04	\$18.80	\$16.51	\$18.69	\$16.26	\$19.32	\$17.70	\$20.26	\$18.49
Unionization rate	20.8%	10.7%	20.5%	9.6%	18.4%	8.9%	16.9%	8.4%	16.4%	9.7%
Part-time rate	20.1%	27.9%	18.9%	28.6%	20.3%	29.2%	19.7%	26.2%	19.3%	23.3%
Government employee	32.7%	1.0%	33.8%	1.8%	30.2%	1.8%	28.5%	1.5%	31.0%	1.5%
Demographics										
Mean age	43.5	39.2	44.8	40.5	45.6	42.2	45.8	42.6	46.0	42.6
Female	30.1%	47.8%	27.9%	46.8%	26.7%	47.2%	28.6%	48.8%	30.1%	52.5%
Black	18.3%	16.8%	18.2%	14.8%	16.9%	17.1%	17.8%	16.7%	16.9%	14.9%
Hispanic	22.8%	44.0%	25.3%	45.2%	25.7%	49.8%	27.6%	47.3%	28.1%	50.8%
Education										
Less than high school	31.9%	43.9%	27.1%	38.8%	23.0%	36.6%	21.5%	32.7%	18.4%	29.0%
High school / GED	46.4%	40.6%	48.2%	41.2%	47.7%	42.7%	48.6%	44.3%	48.5%	44.6%
Some college	18.0%	12.4%	20.4%	14.6%	23.8%	16.1%	23.4%	17.3%	24.8%	18.7%
Bachelor's or higher	3.7%	3.1%	4.4%	5.3%	5.5%	4.6%	6.5%	5.8%	8.3%	7.8%
Sample										
Unweighted N (regression sample)	11,796	2,669	10,850	2,640	10,533	2,889	7,752	2,243	6,752	2,232
Workers represented (thousands)	1,625	403	1,601	410	1,639	484	1,644	544	1,489	567

Data: CPS-ORG via IPUMS. Years: 2001-2025, 2020 excluded. Part-time = usual hours under 30. Weights: EARNWT. Statistics use the author's regression sample (non-missing log_wage and every model covariate); N = observations with non-missing wages and all model covariates. Workers represented is average monthly employment estimated from EARNWT on all sampled base-sample workers, including those excluded for missing wages or covariates: sum(EARNWT) divided by the number of distinct survey months (ym) for that occupation in the period, in thousands, rounded to the nearest thousand. FE: state x year and clustering by survey month (ym) apply to regression tables only; Tables 1-2 are descriptive. Stars: * p<.10, ** p<.05, *** p<.01, two-tailed.